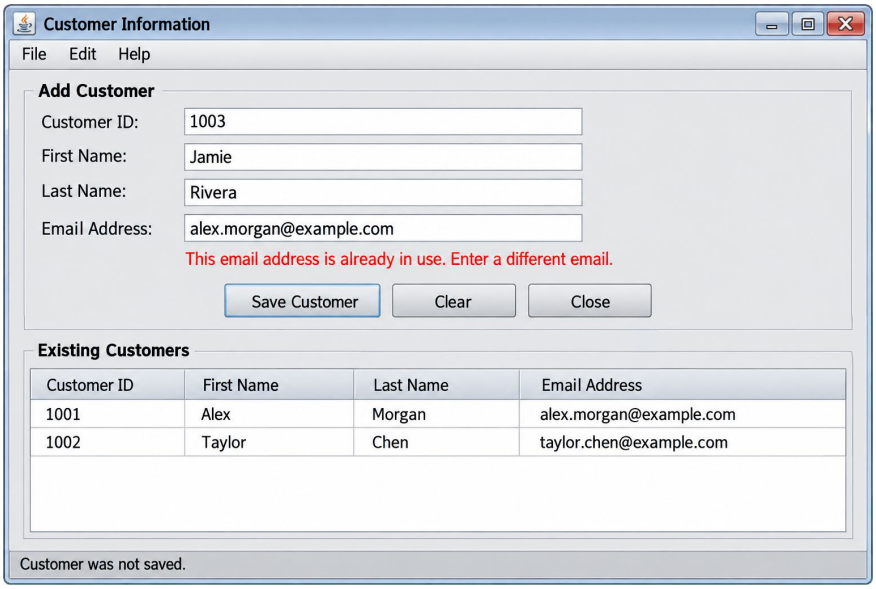
Writing for a Technical and Non-Technical Audience

Writing for a technical audience and a non-technical audience requires different levels of detail, vocabulary, and explanation. Both audiences need clear, accurate information, but they may use that information for different purposes.

For a **non-technical audience**, focus on what the information means, why it matters, and how it affects the reader. Use familiar words, explain necessary technical terms, and connect unfamiliar ideas to everyday examples. For instance, you might describe a database as "an organized collection of information that makes records easy to find and update."

For a **technical audience**, include the details readers need to understand, evaluate, or implement a solution. Depending on the topic, these might include methods, specifications, code examples, assumptions, and limitations. Technical terms can improve precision when readers understand them. However, technical expertise does not eliminate the need for clear explanations and logical organization.

For example, a non-technical explanation might state, "The system prevents duplicate customer records." A technical explanation might state, "A UNIQUE constraint on the customer's email address prevents duplicate values in that column."



Effective writing begins with understanding the audience's knowledge and purpose. The goal is to give readers enough information to act without overwhelming them or leaving out essential details.